

To list the total files, links and directories in the current folder non-recursively, use the following:

```
for t in files links directories;
```

```
do echo `find . -maxdepth 1 -type ${t:0:1} | wc -l` $t;
done 2> /dev/null
```

Here are the results:

```
1101 files
3 links
233 directories
```

—Swapnil Jain,
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Empty a file using cat

To delete the contents of a large text file just run the following command:

```
$cat /dev/null > filename
```

—Prashant Shah,
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Running a task in the background while exiting the console

Sometimes you may have to run a script in the background but may want to exit the console before it finishes. If you quit the console, your task also quits as it is a child process. The best way to solve this issue is to use the *nohup* command. Given below is the syntax to do so:

```
# nohup <command> &
```

Here is an example:

```
# nohup ping www.yahoo.com &
```

```
[1] 5556
```

```
# nohup: appending output to 'nohup.out'
```

You can exit the console now, and later log in and open the *nohup.out* file to see the output of the command.

—Yogindar Das Y,
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How to find all files of different extensions with one find command

You can easily find all files of different extensions with the *find* command, by using the *-o* option.

Let's suppose you want to find all the files of type *.cc, *.c, *.h and Makefile. You can use the following *find* command:

```
#find . -name Makefile -o -name '*.cc' -o -name '*.c' -o
```

```
-name '*.h'
```

This will be useful if you want to create the *cscope.files* and various other tasks, which include your source code files.

—Yogindar Das Y,
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How to open the last edited file

To open the last edited file in the current directory, use the combination of the *ls*, *head* and *vi* commands as shown below.

Open *file 1* and make changes.

```
$ vim file1
```

Save and close the file.

Now open *file 2* and make changes.

```
$ vim file2
```

Save and close the file.

Next, run the following command to open the last edited file:

```
$ vim `ls -t | head -1`
```

Here, *ls -t* sorts the file based on the time of modification, showing the last edited file first. *head -1* picks up this first file and opens it in the *vim* text editor.

—Surendra Patil,
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How to answer 'Yes' for every question, automatically

If you are tired of pressing 'y' over and over again for a program in which your answer is always 'y', you can use the 'Yes' command to automate the process.

Here's the syntax:

```
yes | <command which needs your answer many times>
```

The above command will always provide 'y' as the answer.

If you want to say 'No', use the following:

```
yes n | <command which needs your answer many times>
```

—Sumit Kumar,
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END

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